- **Relief maps** show general topography like mountains valleys, plains, plateaus and rivers.
- **Geological maps** are drawn to show geological structures, rocks and minerals.
- **Climatic maps** show the distribution of temperature, rainfall, clouds, relative humidity, direction and velocity of winds and other elements of weather.
- **Soil maps** which are drawn to show the distribution of different types of soil and their properties.

Cultural maps which shows the man-made features are called cultural maps.

- **Political maps** show the administrative divisions of a country, state or district. These maps facilitate the administration in planning and management of the concerned administrative units.
- **Population maps** show the distribution, density and growth of population, occupation structure and literacy.
- **Economic maps** depict the production and distribution of different types of crops and minerals, location of industries, trade routes and flow of commodities.
- **Transportation maps** show roads, railway lines and the location of railway station, airports and seaports, etc.,
- **Thematic maps** represent the distribution of a particular feature or theme and its spatial variation.



Digital maps is a web-based service that provides detailed information about geographical regions and sites around the world.

Elements of maps

Maps provide us with a lot of information and one must know how to read and interpret them. Every map is provided with certain features that help us to study the information presented in it. The basic essential elements of a map are title, direction, scale and legend (or) key and signs and symbols.

Title

Every map has a title that describes the information given in the map. For example, a map with the title India Rivers shows Rivers of India.

Direction

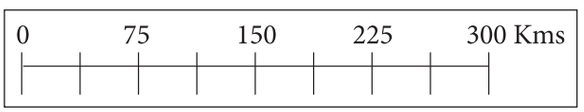
In general maps are drawn with North orientation. It helps us to find other direction on the map like East, West and South. In addition to the North notation, latitudes and longitudes are depicted in the margins. The North is notified by letter 'N' with an arrow mark.





Scale

The scale of a map is the ratio between the distance on the map between two points and actual distance between the two places on the ground. For example the scales can be represented as 1cm = 10km. It means 1cm on the map is equal to 10 km on the ground. It helps to find the distance on the map between two points.



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